As a consequence of Modi's leadership and his personal conviction, as well as the demands of the changing regional balance of power, India has significantly expanded the scale and scope of its bilateral engagement with the United States. Since the end of the Cold War, successive Indian governments have signalled a commitment to a robust partnership with the United States. Yet previous governments remained wary of too close a partnership, mainly on account of weak political coalitions but also because of their reluctance to shed the ideological remnants of India's Cold War foreign policy in the form of non-alignment. Rather than providing a broad direction for foreign policy, they often became excuses to cover foreign policy paralysis in the Indian establishment, most notably during the second term of the UPA government. The delay in signing the LEMOA and resolution of the Civil Nuclear Liability bill are cases in point. Resolution of these differences by the Modi government signalled not only its pragmatism but also an ideological commitment to Indo–US strategic partnership that was hitherto missing. This signalling of the importance of Indo–US partnership in the Indian foreign policy matrix is the most important change the Modi government has ushered in India's US policy. It has heralded a new foreign policy dynamic whereby robust Indo–US ties are viewed as important to enhance India's strategic autonomy, as opposed to the traditional view of non-alignment, which sees a close relationship with the United States constraining Indian foreign policy options.

Even a US presidency as transactional as Donald Trump's has largely made all the right noises about India. If Prime Minister Modi could argue that India and the United States have overcome "the hesitations of history" under the Obama administration, he wooed the Trump administration during his initial outreach when he suggested that "the convergence of my vision for 'New India' and President Trump's vision for making America great again will add new